

Paul Nicklen's *Polar Obsession*



For most people, the Arctic and Antarctica are strange places that we know very little about. Paul Nicklen's collection of photographs and stories, *Polar Obsession*, offers an excellent introduction.

Nicklen grew up on an island in Northern Canada, where he learned all about the outdoors from his Inuit¹ neighbors. Ever since that time, he **has loved** animals, cold weather, and adventure.

As a photojournalist, Nicklen **has spent** a lot of time in icy polar waters. He **has followed** sea lions, **dived** with whales, and **studied** polar bears. One of the most exciting parts of the book covers Nicklen's unforgettable encounter with a leopard seal in Antarctica.

As the photographs clearly show, leopard seals are very large—up to 12 feet (4 meters) long and weighing over 1000 pounds (450 kilograms). They have huge, sharp teeth, and they move quickly through the water searching for food such as fish and penguins.

Leopard seals can be dangerous, but this didn't stop Nicklen from trying to photograph one. When a huge seal approached his boat, Nicklen got into the water. He was shaking with fear, but much to his surprise the seal treated him gently. She even tried to feed him! The seal brought him penguins to eat, and he photographed her. Nicklen says it was the most incredible experience that he **has ever had** as a photographer.

In *Polar Obsession*, Nicklen shows us the beauty of the polar world and his passion for it. He also helps us to understand the importance of protecting it.

¹ **Inuit:** indigenous people living in Arctic regions of Alaska, Canada, and Greenland





2 CHECK. Write the letter of the phrase that completes each sentence.

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|--|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Nicklen's neighbors taught him all about ____ ^d | a. leopard seals can be dangerous |
| 2. Nicklen has spent a lot of time working in ____ ^e | b. a leopard seal |
| 3. Nicklen's most incredible experience was with ____ ^b | c. its food |
| 4. He was frightened because ____ ^a | d . the outdoors |
| 5. The leopard seal offered Nicklen ____ ^c | e. icy polar waters |

3 DISCOVER. Complete the exercises to learn about the grammar in this lesson.

A Find these sentences in the book review from exercise 1. Write the missing words.

- Nicklen grew up on an island in Northern Canada, where he learned all about the outdoors from his Inuit neighbors.
- Ever since that time, he Has loved animals, cold weather, and adventure.
- As a photojournalist Nicklen Has spent a lot of time in icy polar ~~waters~~
- He Has followed sea lions, dived with whales, and studied polar bears.
- When a huge seal approached his boat, Nicklen Has loved the water.

B Look at the sentences in exercise A. Write the number of each sentence next to the phrase that best describes the time of the event.

- Completed at a known time in the past: 1 5
- Completed at an unknown time in the past: 2 3
- Started in the past and continues to the present: 4